



TIPS & TRICKS



Encrypt files using gpg (GNU privacy guard)

Given below are the steps to encrypt and decrypt a file using *gpg*.

Step 1. Encrypting the file:

```
[bash]$ gpg -c filename
```

The above command will ask for a new password. After you enter the new password, *gpg* will create a file with an extension such as *.gpg* in the current directory; this file is in encrypted format.

Step 2. To decrypt a *gpg* encrypted file, again use the *gpg* command as shown below:

```
[bash]$ gpg filename.gpg
```

When you run the above command, you will be asked for a password. After entering the correct password, it will decrypt the file.

—Narendra Kangralkar,
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Use Vim shortcut to align your code

Coding style is an important aspect in any programming language. Here is a tip that will help you align your code while using Vim as an editor for coding.

Just go to the opening or ending brace and enter the command `=%`. The code will be aligned to tabs automatically.

—Vaibhav Hiremath,
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Change the date and time from the command prompt

To set or change the date and time on a Linux system, the *date* command is used. Open the terminal, log in as the root user, and type the following command in the terminal to change the system's date and time:

```
# date -s "20 JULY 2013 18:32:00"
```

Now, check for your date and time, as follows:

```
# date
```

Read the manual pages of the *date* command to know more about it.

—Indranil Kamulkar,
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Mounting Windows share in Linux

To use any shared folder on the network or to create a partition in Linux, first create a mount point and then mount the shared folder or the filesystem. Now, to access the shared folder, mount the Windows share at the newly created mount point.

Type the following command to create the mount point *ntserver*.

```
# mkdir -p /mnt/ntserver
```

And then mount the share using the following command:

```
# mount -t cifs //mswintserver/download -o username=indranil,password=myPassword /mnt/ntserver
```

This mounts the *download* folder of *mswintserver* at */mnt/ntserver*. You can use an IP address in place of the computer name. The above command also shows you how to use a username and password while using a Windows sharing.

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Extract sound from a video file using ffmpeg

Often, we need only the audio from a video. Here is a tip that will explain how to extract an audio clip from a video using the well-known tool *ffmpeg*.